

Tobias Treppmann

Designs the decision in running code, against real data — fifteen years of dense B2B software, the last year of it building with agents

CONTACT

LOCATION

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

PROFILE

I do not hand a design over and hope. I build it in real code against real APIs, and engineering ships from that code. At Bibel TV around 70% of it lands with minor modification. The engineers there are an external agency, so the handoff crosses a company boundary and holds anyway. Worth saying at the top: I direct a model rather than typing the framework. HTML, CSS and some JavaScript are mine by hand, the rest is agentic engineering, and it has been in production for a year. Before that, fifteen years of B2B software for people who never chose to be software users. Analysts inside banks and insurers, parish offices, funeral directors. The last year went into human-agent interfaces: how someone gives an agent context, sees what it did, and stays upstream of the send.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV; engineering is an external agency) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- The design decision gets made in running code — I prototype the product against real APIs, web first and then Android, rather than in clickable mockups. Around 70% of the AI-generated code lands with minor modification and iteration went from days to hours. I direct a model rather than typing the framework; the engineers who take it into production are a separate agency.
- A color engine, and the tool that tunes it — a custom extraction API plus a configuration interface, both live in production. K-means clustering in OKLCH rather than RGB, so themes carry even perceptual weight across a grid. Text is validated against base with the WCAG algorithm, lightness and chroma adjusted until the pair passes. The thresholds are design decisions, which is why design owned the infrastructure. Each one is a dial in the config tool rather than a commit.
- Human-agent interfaces, shipped — an AI support copilot in production for viewer services: assistive drafting for letters, emails and social messages, following the handbook's wording, formatting and standard phrases. An explicit restricted-topic list sits in the system prompt, the draft is suppressed entirely when the input is not a viewer enquiry, and every send decision stays human. Operated manually by the team, and rolled out fully optional.
- Design system as an API — DTCG tokens in three tiers, built with Style Dictionary, synced live to Figma and Android. One commit propagates to every platform, so the high-quality choice is the fast one. Built without a platform team.
- The tickets are mine to write — I spec and prioritize what engineering works from, and check the built feature in production and beta rather than calling it done at handoff.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — ~50 people, DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Booking module — the decision I defended through the build — inherited a €20k client-funded booking project scoped internally as a standalone add-on module and reframed it into a platform capability, choosing deep platform integration over the faster standalone module and holding that line to delivery. 70% coordination-time reduction and 90% acceptance at the launch customer, where funerals had to be bookable across 20+ cemeteries. It then shipped to every customer as a general booking capability — room rentals, baptisms, weddings.
- Three stakeholder groups with opposing needs on one surface — funeral directors, parish assistants and priests, in a workflow where a scheduling mistake is not a minor inconvenience. I held product management for the platform alongside all product design, and was the launch parish's main contact throughout.
- Two engineers, two months, daily contact — design in Figma, build in code, and I was in the build every day rather than at the end of it.
- AI alt-text in production — shipped for EU accessibility compliance under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law, across six countries.

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Prompt-to-database onboarding, with the CEO and technical co-founder (freelance, summer 2025) — the AI-generated schema renders into the real data-model editor, not a chat preview, so people can see and correct what the model produced instead of accepting it blind. It became the basis for the public AI beta.
- On Ninox's Senior Leadership Team, with 5 direct reports including a design lead — and shared design-system governance established at Ninox across 4 designers and engineering.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Five years of data-dense B2B interfaces — big-data pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views, result cards and filter logic. The hardest of them was the query-builder preview, where the result you see is a sample and the interface has to be honest about that without becoming unreadable. Necessary complexity kept, weight kept off.
- Research inside institutions that make users hard to reach — pioneered iterative useresting.com screening to get to analysts working inside banks and insurers. The platform operated under HIPAA compliance among other frameworks.
- Design system — I defined component behavior and specs across the library, and the UI designers executed the visual system. I led the design team across Germany and NYC throughout.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Service-to-product transformation — partnered with the executive team to productize the service organization. Case-by-case support became a standard catalog.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany
UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA
User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA
Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA
Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Düsseldorf, Germany
Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Düsseldorf, Germany
Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Düsseldorf, Germany
E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 · Hagen, Germany

SKILLS

How I Work in Code

Prototypes built in real code against real production APIs, web first then Android · Engineering consumes that code directly and around 70% of it reaches production with minor modification · Iteration moved from days of spec-and-handoff to hours in working code · Engineering at Bibel TV is an external agency, so that handoff crosses a company boundary and holds anyway · The honest split: HTML, CSS and some JavaScript by hand, everything else agentic · I direct the model rather than typing the framework, and I would rather say so now than have you find it in week two

Color, Contrast and Visual Systems

Built Bibel TV's color engine and the tool that configures it, both live in production · K-means clustering in OKLCH rather than RGB, so themes carry even perceptual weight across a grid instead of some cards demanding the page and others disappearing · Low-vibrance clusters filtered so a muddy beige cannot win by covering the most pixels · Text validated against base with the WCAG algorithm, lightness and chroma adjusted until the pair passes, so no theme ships failing · Every threshold a dial in the config tool rather than a commit · Selah — Mindful Transitions: a macOS app designed, built and shipped solo on the Mac App Store

Human-Agent Interfaces

A support copilot live in production, where the person stays upstream of the send · Restricted topics named in an explicit restricted-topic list in the system prompt and the draft suppressed entirely when the input is not a viewer enquiry · Prompt-to-database onboarding at Ninox, where the generated schema renders into the real editor rather than a chat preview, so it can be inspected and corrected instead of accepted blind · An AI fundraising ecosystem built solo end to end, from analysis through prompt architecture and prototype to a production skill

Dense Enterprise Workflows

Five years of data-dense B2B interfaces at Datameer — pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views, result cards, filter logic · The query-builder preview, where the result is a sample and the interface has to say so without becoming unreadable · Three stakeholder groups with opposing needs on one ChurchDesk surface, in a workflow where a scheduling mistake is not a minor inconvenience · Analysts inside top US, Canadian and UK banks and insurers, reached through screening built for institutions that had never granted research access

Design Systems as Infrastructure

Design system as an API at Bibel TV: DTCG tokens in three tiers from global primitives through semantic to component, built with Style Dictionary, synced live to Figma and Android with iOS and web ready · One commit propagates to every platform, which is what makes the high-quality choice the fast one · Governance run as a cross-functional working group with assigned members and an escalation path · Defined component behavior and specs across the Datameer design system, with UI executing the visual system

Tools and Practice

Claude Code, Claude Projects and Claude skills as daily tools, plus Cursor and Zed · Figma and Figma Variables · HTML, CSS, JavaScript · SwiftUI · Storybook · Dovetail and usertesting.com · “Designing with and for AI” workshop series run since 2024 with a partner agency

Where I Have Led

Team of five including a design lead at Ninox, on the Senior Leadership Team · Product management and all of product design held together at ChurchDesk · Design team across Germany and NYC for five years at Datameer · Listed last on purpose — this application is for the work, not the title